STHIROS
Strategy. Risk. Cyber. AI.



When a global SSC turned four years of discipline into $360M

A global Finance & Accounting shared services centre engaged Sthiros for a four-year operational excellence journey, delivering $360M+ in benefits and cutting operational losses by 50%.

Client	Service	Sector	Geography
Global SSC, Finance & Accounting	**Enterprise-Wide Operational Excellence, Process Optimisation & Risk Reduction**	**Shared Services, BPO**	**Global, Multi-Location**

The Challenge:

When manual work caps what scale can deliver

This global SSC ran Finance & Accounting operations across multiple locations, with high email volumes, manual repetitive tasks, and missed payment deadlines. Operational losses and near-miss incidents signalled control weaknesses beneath the surface.

Email-Driven Bottlenecks
High email volumes created processing delays and communication gridlock.

Missed Payment Deadlines
Missed-by-INVO percentages impacted client satisfaction and vendor trust.

Inconsistent Accuracy
Accuracy levels varied widely across different service offerings.

Control Weaknesses
Operational losses and near-miss incidents exposed governance gaps.

Lengthy Loan TAT
Loan processing and other critical services ran on lengthy turnaround times.

Suboptimal Work Allocation
No specialised skill deployment existed to match work to expertise.

The Solution:

Four years, four phases, one compounding position

Sthiros ran a phased, multi-year transformation combining lean standardisation, Six Sigma productivity improvements, hyper-specialisation, and digitisation, one year building on the last.

Every intervention was tracked through risk control matrices and a Process Governance Portal, with ITGC and VAPT readiness maintained throughout the journey.

The Methodology

Year 1

Standardisation & Six Sigma Foundations ($2.8M)

Processes standardised and documented across every service line, with baseline productivity metrics and Six Sigma Yellow and Green Belt training established.

Year 2

Lean Rapid Improvement & Events ($3.4M)

Kaizen events targeted specific bottlenecks, with value stream mapping and low-cost automation cutting email volume by 15%.

Year 3

Hyper-Specialisation & Industrialisation ($4.1M)

Specialised processing pods and skill-based routing replaced generic workflows, improving Quality, Cost & Delivery by 50%.

Year 4

Innovation & Digitisation Agenda ($5.2M)

Straight-Through-Processi ng, digital channels, and RPA deployment delivered 73% time savings through low-cost automation.

What This Means

Four years, one maturity curve.

Automation cuts processing time by 73%.

Fewer errors mean fewer losses.

Outcomes

$360M+

Total benefits delivered

Across a four-year operational excellence transformation programme.

50%

Operational loss reduction

Near-miss incidents and losses cut through enhanced controls and governance.

62%

Personal Loan C2C TAT cut

Delivering $350M of the total benefit through turnaround time reduction alone.

73%

Time savings via automation

Low-cost automation and RPA deployed against repetitive, manual tasks.

Get in touch

Is your SSC optimised, or just staffed?

Speak to Sthiros about what a multi-year operational excellence journey can unlock for your shared services function.

Connect with us:
sthiros.com

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